

Julia Cataldo

julia.cataldo@nyu.edu

New York University | Linguistics Department
10 Washington Place, New York, NY 10003, USA

EDUCATION

- 2023 – 2028 **New York University (NYU)**
PhD in Linguistics
Advisor: Liina Pylkkänen
- 2021 – 2023 **Federal University of Rio de Janeiro (UFRJ)**
MA in Linguistics
Advisor: Aniela França
Thesis: Restaurant to restore? An EEG study on the neurophysiological path of diachrony in lexical access
- 2015 – 2020 **Federal University of Rio de Janeiro (UFRJ)**
BA in Letters (Portuguese and French)
Advisor: Aniela França
Thesis: Lexical access: specificities of the semantic and morphological routes
- Spring 2018 **Sorbonne University (Université Paris IV)**
Undergraduate academic exchange

RESEARCH POSITIONS

- Winter 2025 **Graduate Assistant** for Prof. Lucas Champollion, at NYU
Tested the Lambda Calculator.
- Fall 2023 **Graduate Research Assistant** for Prof. Tal Linzen, at NYU
Conducted eye-tracking experiments.
- May 2019 **Research Assistant** for Prof. Annie Kuyucumhan, at Université de Strasbourg
Analyzed students' errors in written French to develop a teaching program and an AI teaching mentor.
- 2016 – 2017 **Research Assistant** for Prof. Andrew Nevins, at UFRJ
Conducted psycholinguistic research on Brazilian Portuguese defective verbs and the allomorphy of the diminutives -inho/-zinho in proparoxytone words.
- 2012 – 2013 **School Guide & Research Assistant**, at MN/UFRJ (Brazilian National Museum of Natural History)
Mediated school and touristic tours in the museum, developed scientific and educational research.
- Spring and Fall 2011 **Research Assistant** for Dr. Eduardo de Biase, at Colégio Pedro II
Conducted sociological research on contemporary beauty standards.

PRIZES

Awards

- 2021 **Leipzig Lectures on Language Best Poster Presentation**, Max-Planck-Gesellschaft
- 2021, 2017 **Honorable mention for outstanding research communication**, UFRJ XLII & XXIX Acad. Weeks

Fellowships

- 2026 **GSAS Dean's Conference Fund**, New York University (\$750)
- 2025 **GSAS Dean's Conference Fund**, New York University (\$500)
- 2023-2028 **Henry M. MacCracken Fellowship**, for a fully funded PhD position at New York University
- 2022-2023 **Nota 10 Master Fellowship**, FAPERJ (Carlos Chagas RJ Foundation for Research - awarded to the best master student of the graduate program)
- 2021-2022 **Excellency Master Fellowship**, UFRJ/CAPES (Federal Coordination for Higher Educ. Research)
- 2017 **Teaching initiation Fellowship**, PIBID/CAPES (Federal Coordination for Higher Educ. Research)
- 2016 **Thomas Gardner Scholarship**, Oxford Royale Academy Summer School (not claimed)
- 2016 **Scientific Initiation Fellowship**, UFRJ/CNPq (National Council for Sci. & Tech. Develop.)
- 2012-2013 **Young Talents for Science Fellowship**, FAPERJ (Carlos Chagas RJ Foundation for Research)

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed journals

- subm. **Cataldo, J**; Rodriguez, A; Pykkänen, L. What remains of short visual messages? MEG evidence on the short-term persistence of linguistic representations in RPVP.
- subm. Nevins, A; Postma, G; **Cataldo, J**. *Figadinho: defectivity of the diminutive and the three-syllable window.
- 2021 **Cataldo, J**; França, A. Friend or foe: the morphological kinship between words. *Cadernos de Linguística*, 2:e499 [Written in Portuguese; Original title: Um estranho no ninho: o parentesco morfológico entre palavras].
- 2021 Gomes, F; Gonçalves, C; **Cataldo, J**; Assis, C. Teaching internships as a space for critical thinking for students and teachers: an experience at CAP UFRJ during pandemic times. *SobreTudo*, 12(1), pp. 163-190. [Written in Portuguese; Original title: O estágio como espaço de formação crítica docente e discente: uma experiência no CAP UFRJ em tempos de pandemia].
- 2020 Gomes, JN; **Cataldo, J**. Might language be telepathy? *Revista da ABRALIN*, 19, pp. 1-7. [Bilingual publication; Portuguese version: Gomes JN, **Cataldo, J** (2020). Pode a língua ser telepatia? *Revista da ABRALIN*, 19, pp. 1-7].

Conference proceedings

- 2025 **Cataldo, J**, França, A. Fundamental research in neuroscience that impacted the state of the art of linguistic research. In: *Proceedings of the VIII Scientiarum Historia National Conference*, Rio de Janeiro: UFRJ. [Written in Portuguese; Original title: Pesquisas fundamentais em neurociência que impactaram o estado-da-arte da pesquisa linguística].

PRESENTATIONS

Invited talks

- 2026 Nevins, A; Postma, G; **Cataldo, J**. *Figadinho: defectivity of the diminutive and the three-syllable window. In: *Beijing Chinese Language and Culture College (BCLC)*. Beijing, China.
- 2025 **Cataldo, J**. Priming in comprehension with RPVP: an MEG study. In: *ACESIN Lab, UFRJ*. Rio de Janeiro, RJ, Brazil
- 2024 **Cataldo, J**. Pre-registration: what it is and why you should do it. In: *ACESIN Lab, UFRJ*. Rio de Janeiro, RJ, Brazil
- 2022 **Cataldo, J**; Sabatini, F. Experimental methods to study lexical access. In: *II Seminar on Language and Cognition, UNICAMP*. Campinas, SP, Brazil. *Online*.
- 2018 Nevins, A; **Cataldo, J**; Dutra, V. An Experimental investigation into defective verbs in BP: rhizotonicity vs theme vowels. In: *12th Workshop on Formal Linguistics, UFPR*. Curitiba, PR, Brazil

Talks

- 2026 **Cataldo, J**. Magnetoencephalography and language: advantages, applications and methodological challenges. In: *71º Seminário do GEL (Grupo de Estudos da Linguagem do Estado de São Paulo)*. Araraquara, SP, Brazil.
- 2026 **Cataldo, J**; França, A. Restaurant to restore? An EEG study on the neuropsychological path of diachrony in lexical access. In: 13th ISAPL (Congress of the International Society of Applied Psycholinguistics). Porto, Portugal.
- 2025 **Cataldo, J**. An MEG study of structural priming during comprehension using the RPVP paradigm. In: *SYNC (Stony Brook, Yale, NYU and CUNY student-led linguistics conference) – CUNY edition*. NYC, NY, USA.
- 2023 **Cataldo, J**. Friend or foe: the morphological kinship between words. In: *SYNC (Stony Brook, Yale, NYU and CUNY student-led linguistics conference) – Stony Brook edition*. Long Island, NY, USA.
- 2022 **Cataldo, J**. Testing semantic opacity and affix stripping in lexical access with EEG. In: *XXVII SEPLA (Linguistics Graduate Program Conference), UFRJ*. Rio de Janeiro, RJ, Brazil.
- 2021 **Cataldo, J**. Friend or foe: the morphological kinship between words. In: *XXXVII APL (Annual Meeting of the Portuguese Linguistics Association)*. Lisbon, Portugal. *Online*.
- 2021 **Cataldo, J**. Friend or foe: the morphological kinship between words. In: *XII ABRALIN (Conference of the Brazilian Linguistics Association)*. Campinas, Brazil. *Online*.
- 2021 Soto, M; Gomes, J; França, A; **Cataldo, J**; Gesualdi, A. Using ERP and the Divided Visual Field Paradigm to explore hemispheric specialization as a predictive and descriptive tool for grapheme and word processing. *Words in the World Conference*. Canada. *Online*.

- 2021 Soto, M; Gomes, J; França, A; **Cataldo, J**, Gesualdi A. Using ERP and the Divided Visual Field Paradigm to explore hemispheric specialization as a predictive and descriptive tool for grapheme and word processing. *XIX Conference of the Association of Linguistics and Philology of Latin America*. Latin America. Online.
- 2021 Soto, M; Gomes, J; França, A; **Cataldo, J**, Gesualdi A. Using ERP and the Divided Visual Field Paradigm to explore hemispheric specialization as a predictive and descriptive tool for grapheme and word processing. *XLIV Annual Meeting of the Brazilian Society of Neuroscience and Behavior*. Brazil. Online.
- 2021 **Cataldo, J**; França, A. Friend or foe: the morphological kinship between words. In: *III SELIV (Seminário de Estudos Linguísticos do Vale da Paraíba)*, IF. Campos do Jordão, SP, Brazil.
- 2021 **Cataldo, J**; França, A. Friend or foe: the morphological kinship between words. In: *III Generative Grammar Meeting, in homage of Cyrino and Duarte*, UFBA. Salvador, BA, Brazil.
- 2021 **Cataldo, J**. Affix stripping and semantic opacity in lexical access an EEG study. In: *XXVI SEPLA (Linguistics Graduate Program Conference)*, UFRJ. Rio de Janeiro, RJ, Brazil.
- 2020 **Cataldo, J**; Ferreira, R. The flipped classroom in online learning. In: *I Seminário CLAC/UFRJ*. Rio de Janeiro, RJ, Brazil.
- 2020 **Cataldo, J**; Franca, A. Lexical access: evaluating the semantic and morphological routes. In: *XLII Jornada Guilio Massarini de Iniciação Científica, Tecnológica, Artística e Cultural*, UFRJ. Rio de Janeiro, RJ, Brazil.
- 2019 **Cataldo, J**; Franca A. Lexical access: evaluating the semantic and morphological routes. In: *Experimental Working Group, Laboratoire de Linguistique Formelle, Université Paris Diderot*. Paris, France.
- 2015 **Cataldo, J**; França, A. Fundamental research in neuroscience that impacted the state of the art of linguistic research. In: *XXXVII Jornada Giulio Massarini de Iniciação científica, tecnológica, artística e cultural da UFRJ*. Rio de Janeiro, RJ, Brazil.
- 2012 **Cataldo, J**; Ribeiro, G. Mornings in the park: a historic and environmental route in the former Imperial Quinta, by the Brazilian National Museum. In: *Jornada Jovens Talentos*, Universidade Severino Sombra. Vassouras, RJ, Brazil.

Posters

- 2026 **Cataldo, J**; Marantz, A. Final-over-Final Condition or Headedness Harmony Constraint? Investigating Brazilian Portuguese derivational morphology via structural priming. In: *30+20 years of psico+neuro at UFRJ*. Rio de Janeiro, RJ, Brazil.
- 2026 **Cataldo, J**; Rodriguez, A; Pykkänen, L. Lexical and structural priming in RPVP-reading. In: *CogSci 2026 (Cognitive Science Society Annual Meeting)*. Rio de Janeiro, RJ, Brazil.
- 2025 **Cataldo, J**; Rodriguez, A; Pykkänen, L. Structural priming in comprehension with RPVP. In: *SNL 2025 (Annual Meeting for the Society for the Neurobiology of Language)*. Washington, DC, USA.
- 2022 **Cataldo, J**; França, A. Friend or foe: the morphological kinship between words. In: *The International Max Planck Research School Conference on Interdisciplinary Approaches in the Language Sciences*. Nijmegen, Netherlands. Online.
- 2021 **Cataldo, J**; França, A. Friend or foe: the morphological kinship between words. In: *Leipzig Lectures on Language, Max-Planck-Gesellschaft*. Leipzig, Germany. Online. **Best presentation award**
- 2021 **Cataldo, J**; França, A. Friend or foe: the morphological kinship between words. In: *Words in the World Conference*. Canada. Online.
- 2019 **Cataldo, J**; Franca A. Lexical access: evaluating the semantic and morphological routes. In: *I Open School in Linguistics*, UFRJ. Rio de Janeiro, RJ, Brazil.
- 2018 Pinto, M; Costa, S; Andrade, I; Dias, S; Leal, K; Goffredo, C; Silva, E; **Cataldo, J**; França, A; Lage, A. Executive functions and the role-playing test in experiments with children. In: *XXIII SEPLA (Linguistics Graduate Program Conference)*, UFRJ. Rio de Janeiro, RJ, Brazil.
- 2017 **Cataldo, J**; Franca A. Lexical access: evaluating the semantic and morphological routes. In: *X ABRALIN (Conference of the Brazilian Linguistics Association)*, UFF. Niterói, RJ, Brazil.
- 2015 **Cataldo, J**; França, A. Fundamental research in neuroscience that has impacted the state of the art of linguistic research. In: *VIII Scientiarum Historia (History of Sciences and Techniques and Epistemology)*, UFRJ. Brazil.
- 2013 **Cataldo, J**; Villas-Boas, S. Mornings in the park: an educational project at the Brazilian National Museum. In: *XV Jornada Jovens Talentos*, UNIFESO. Teresópolis, RJ, Brazil.

Flash Talks

- 2022 **Cataldo, J**; França, A. Friend or foe: the morphological kinship between words. *The 35th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing*. Santa Cruz, CA, USA. *Online*.
- 2021 **Cataldo, J**; França, A. Friend or foe: the morphological kinship between words. *SNL (Annual Meeting of the Society for the Neurobiology of Language)*. *Online*.
- 2021 **Cataldo, J**; França, A. Friend or foe: the morphological kinship between words. In: *Open Podium of the Eastern Generative Grammar Summer School*. Prague, Czech Republic. *Online*.
- 2021 **Cataldo, J**; França, A. Morphological competence and neural mechanisms in lexical access through reading semantically opaque Brazilian Portuguese words. *8th Summer Neurolinguistics School*. Moscow, Russia. *Online*.

Other modalities

- 2022 (Panel discussion) **Cataldo, J**. Girl talk: Possible professional paths in the humanities. In: *Museum of Astronomy and Related Sciences*. Rio de Janeiro, RJ, Brazil.
- 2021 (Tweeter event) **Cataldo, J**; França, A. Friend or foe: the morphological kinship between words. In: *Linguistweets 2 (Brazilian Linguistics Association)*, @linguistweets.

TEACHING

Undergraduate

- Spring 2026 **LING-UA 1: Language**, at NYU
Teaching Assistant for Gary Thoms
- Fall 2025 **LING-UA 43: Neural Bases of Language**, at NYU
Teaching Assistant for Liina Pykkänen
- Spring 2025 **PSYCH-UA 1: Introduction to Psychology**, at NYU
Course Assistant for Jay van Bavel
- Spring and Fall 2016 **LEF140: Foundations of Linguistics**, at UFRJ
Teaching Assistant for all lecturing professors (Maria Cezário, Priscilla Marques, Adriana Martins, Diogo Pinheiro, and Maria Carlota Rosa)

Middle and High School

- Spring 2020 **Portuguese Language and Composition**, at Colégio MOPI
Teaching Assistant for all teachers
- Fall 2020 **Portuguese Language**, at Colégio Estadual Amaro Cavalcanti
Teaching Assistant for Andrea Brum
- Fall 2020 **French Language**, at Colégio de Aplicação da UFRJ
Teaching Assistant for Flávia Gomes and Catarina Gonçalves
- 2018 – 2019 **Portuguese Language and Brazilian Culture**, at Lycée Camille Sée (Colmar, France), Lycée Montaigne (Mulhouse, France) and Collège Kennedy (Mulhouse, France)
Teaching Assistant for Marie Ferreira and Fernanda Da Silva-Heyberger

Language Courses

- 2017 – 2020 **French Language (Basic to Advanced)**, at CLAC-UFRJ Language Courses for the Community
Main instructor, advised by university professors
- Spring and Fall 2017 **French Language (Basic)**, at Colégio Estadual Amaro Cavalcanti
Main instructor, advised by university professors

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

- 2022 **Computational Neuroscience Course – NeuroMatch Academy (NMA)**, 3 weeks
Project: *The flow of decision-making and task difficulty in mice: serial or parallel activation*

SKILLS

- Experimental hardware** EEG, MEG, eye-tracking
- Data collection** PsychoPy, EPrime3, OpenSesame, PClbex, jsPsych, Prolific, Qualtrics
- Data analysis** Python (including MNE-python), R
- Documentation** Microsoft Office, Markdown, LaTeX

Languages

Native: Portuguese; Advanced: English, French; Intermediate: Spanish; Beginner: Italian

SERVICE AND OUTREACH

Service positions

- 2026-2028 **Colloquium Committee, NYU**
Organized colloquia talks at NYU.
- 2024-2025 **LANYU Linguistics Association of NYU**
Copresident: Served as the primary contact for graduate students in NYU's Linguistics department; Attended faculty meetings as the students' representative; Organized events, including the department's open house.
- 2021 **Committee for Academic Events - UFRJ Linguistics Graduate Program**
Member: Organized all events hosted by the Graduate Program, including Colloquium Talks, yearly internal graduate students' seminar (SEPLA), and yearly professional developmental seminars.
- 2019 **Brazilian Linguistics Olympiad (Ye'pã-masa Edition)**
Test corrector for short answer questions.
- 2018 **Maison 13 Solidaire,**
Tutor: Helped immigrant elementary students with their homework.
- 2016-2017 **Enactus UFRJ**
HR representative and member of the projects *Teto Verde* (helping favela residents to build green roofs in order to lower thermic sensation) and *Citros* (helping favela residents to produce mosquito repellents so they could prevent dengue contraction). The goal of all projects was to use knowledge built inside academia to improve the life of people in vulnerable positions.

Reviewer

- 2025 **SYNC Conference – CUNY edition**, Abstract reviewer
- 2025 **Cognitive Science Society Annual Meeting**, Paper reviewer
- 2024 **SYNC Conference – NYU edition**, Abstract reviewer
- 2022 **InCognitus Seminar**, Abstract reviewer

Organizer

- 2024 **SYNC** (Stony Brook, Yale, NYU & CUNY student-led linguistics conference) – NYU edition, Organizer
- 2022 **II Incognitus Seminar in Linguistics and Cognition** at UNICAMP, Organizer
- 2022 **ABERLING (Linguistics Graduate Program Yearly Opening Event)** at UFRJ, Organizer
- 2021 **III EAL (Open School in Linguistics)** at UFRJ, Organizer
- 2021 **SEPLA (Linguistics Graduate Program Yearly Conference)** at UFRJ, Organizer
- 2021 **Open Podium Seminar** at EGG (Eastern Generative Grammar Summer School), Organizer
- 2017 **TEDxUFRJ**, Organizer – Head of Talks' Curators